

Still waters

A freshwater lake is a large body of standing water. Lakes support a wide variety of life, especially at their edges.

Water hyacinth

Just floating around

Plants that float do well in still water, but they can take over. Water hyacinth looks pretty, but it is a fast-growing weed and can choke other life under a thick mat.

Floating plants such as water lettuce provide shade for a lake's creatures.

Cat in the water

Catfish are named for their barbels, cat-like whiskers that allow them to feel their way in murky water.

Water lettuce

Bullhead catfish

Some species of catfish can grow to be more than 3 m (10 ft) in length.

Barbels help the fish to seek out prey. In the case of a large catfish, this may be a duck.

Is it a sucker?

Paddle in a muddy lake and you may emerge to find a leech on your foot. Some, but not all, leeches suck blood.

Medicinal leech

Horse leech